XCITY

International Masterplanning & Urban Design Competition

Professional Practice Track

Design Brief
Approximately 1,656 km²
Site-wide framework · Phase 1 · Focus areas

Initial ideas of up to 10 pages → Five shortlisted teams
Total design honoraria and awards: US$300,000



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A Site information

Competition overview

XCITY proposes a new city in San Juan Province, Argentina, with energy, computing and productive land at its foundation. This competition invites professional practices and multidisciplinary consortia to develop a site-wide framework, a Phase 1 urban design and proposals for key places within the city.

Item	Requirement
Location and site	San Juan Province, in the Andean foothills of western Argentina. Competition area: approximately 1,656 km².
Early works area	Fixed pilots: agrivoltaic fields 01–03 (13.9 km²) and the Phase 1 living quarter (2.48 km², outline only). XCITY delivers both; proposals connect to them without redesigning them.
Participation	Registration is free. All applicants follow the same application requirements, eligibility review and selection criteria.
Stage 1	Register online, receive a private link by email, then complete the online qualification form and uploads, including an initial-ideas PDF of 1-10 pages. Eligibility is checked before ideas, experience and team are assessed to select five teams.
Stage 2	The five shortlisted teams develop full proposals after appointment and receipt of the brief and common site information package. Briefings and Q&A; will be online.
Honoraria and award	Each valid Stage 2 submission earns US$50,000. One winner receives an additional US$50,000. Total: US$300,000.
Further services	Any subsequent design commission, fees and rights to adapt or implement the work will be negotiated under a separate agreement.

The design challenge

XCITY proposes a new city in San Juan where energy, computing, agriculture and related industries form the economic foundation. The challenge is to show how these activities can sustain jobs, permanent homes, public services and everyday life, and how a city can take shape on this particular site.

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

How can this land become a city people choose to live in? Where should it begin, and how can the first phase bring production and everyday life together within available resources?

01 From production to urban life

Identify who will work and live here, and how economic activity creates jobs and demand for services. Relate population, housing and public provision to credible energy, computing and agricultural capacity.

02 Let the site shape the plan

Water availability, terrain, seasonal drainage, intense sun, wind and dust should determine siting, density, streets and open space. Explain where to build, where to produce and what to protect.

03 Make the first phase work

Provide access, water, power, productive activity, housing and services in an operational first phase. Show how it can function if later development is delayed and what should trigger expansion.

Translate changes in work, services and movement enabled by AI agents, robotics and autonomous vehicles into the design of streets, blocks and key places.

Regional context

Population

San Juan Province had 822,853 residents in the 2022 census, around 20% more than in 2010. Population is concentrated in Greater San Juan.

Mining

Mineral exports reached US$1.467 billion in 2024, accounting for 81.2% of provincial exports. Gold mining and emerging copper projects form an important regional economic base.

Agriculture

San Juan is Argentina’s second-largest wine-growing province, with 19.8% of national vineyard area in 2024. Pistachios, olives and related processing are also relevant to the region.

Energy

The source brief records 21 operating solar plants and 547.4 MW of installed capacity at the end of 2024. Solar generation supplied approximately 54% of provincial electricity demand that year.

Water

Irrigated agriculture depends on the San Juan River and reservoirs including Los Caracoles, Punta Negra and Ullum. Drought and variable supply make water availability a central planning consideration.

Connections and seismic risk

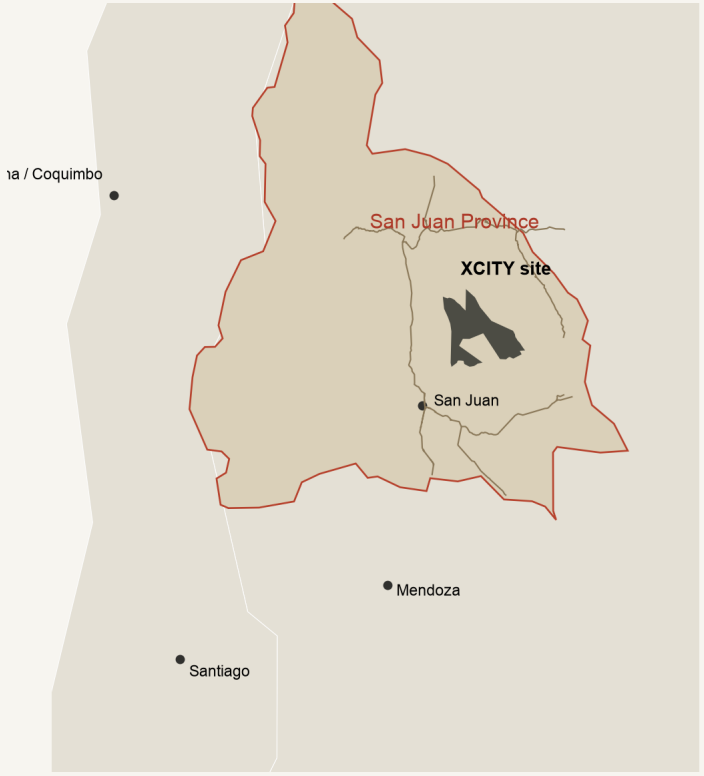
RN 150 connects towards Chile via the high-altitude Agua Negra pass. Seasonal access must be distinguished from future tunnel proposals. San Juan’s earthquake history makes resilience and emergency access essential.

Regional background is retained from the source brief, with the stated reference years. Provincial totals are context, not evidence of water rights, grid capacity or demand available to the project.

Location



South America · San Juan Province



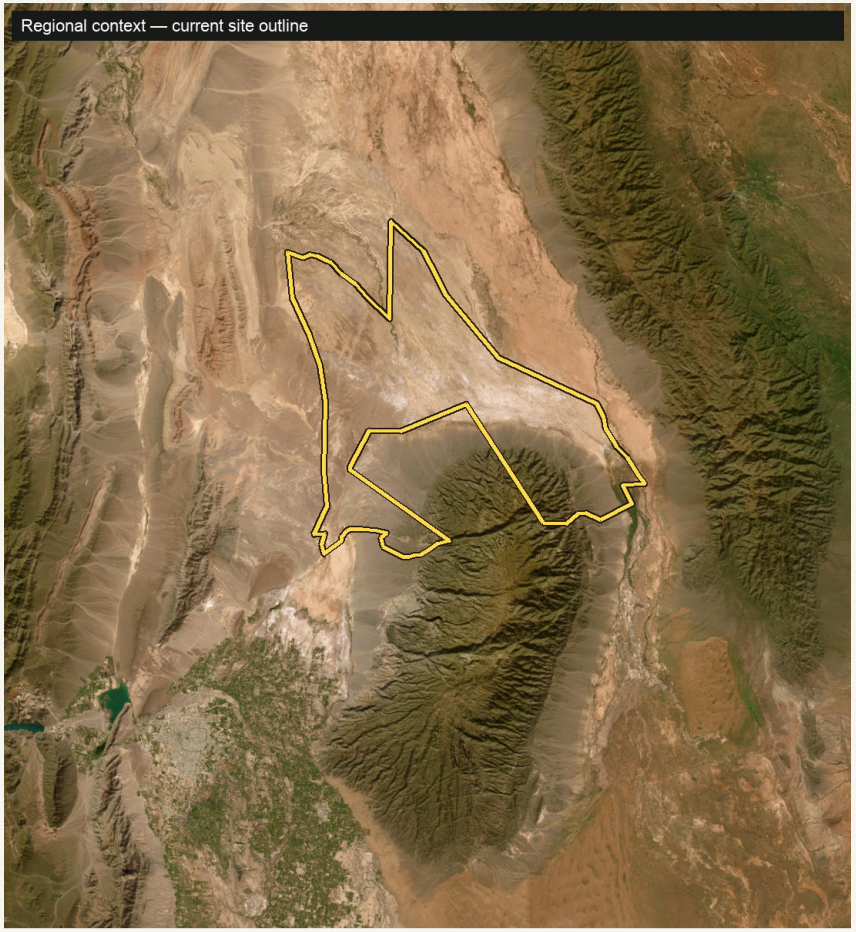
San Juan and the surrounding region

The site lies northeast of San Juan city, in the Andean foothills of western Argentina. Its regional relationships include existing settlements, agriculture, mining services and transport links across Argentina and towards Chile.

Explain how Phase 1 will share services, jobs, procurement and transport with existing places. Regional studies may extend beyond the site; this does not imply development rights outside it.

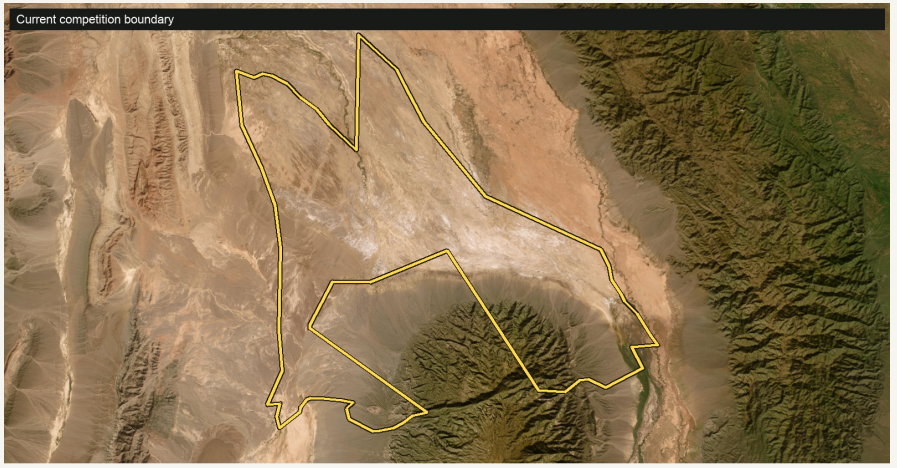
Base maps: Natural Earth. Provincial boundaries: amCharts geodata. Competition boundary: XCITY project information. For regional orientation only.

Location and access



Source: Esri, Vantor, Earthstar Geographics, and the GIS User Community
Accessed 2026-10-27 | multi-date mosaic, not a site survey
Boundary: 2026-10-27-open-seam-closure

Satellite mosaic: Esri World Imagery; credits are shown on the image. Accessed 27 October 2026. Acquisition dates vary across the mosaic. The yellow outline is drawn from the current open-seam-closure GeoJSON.

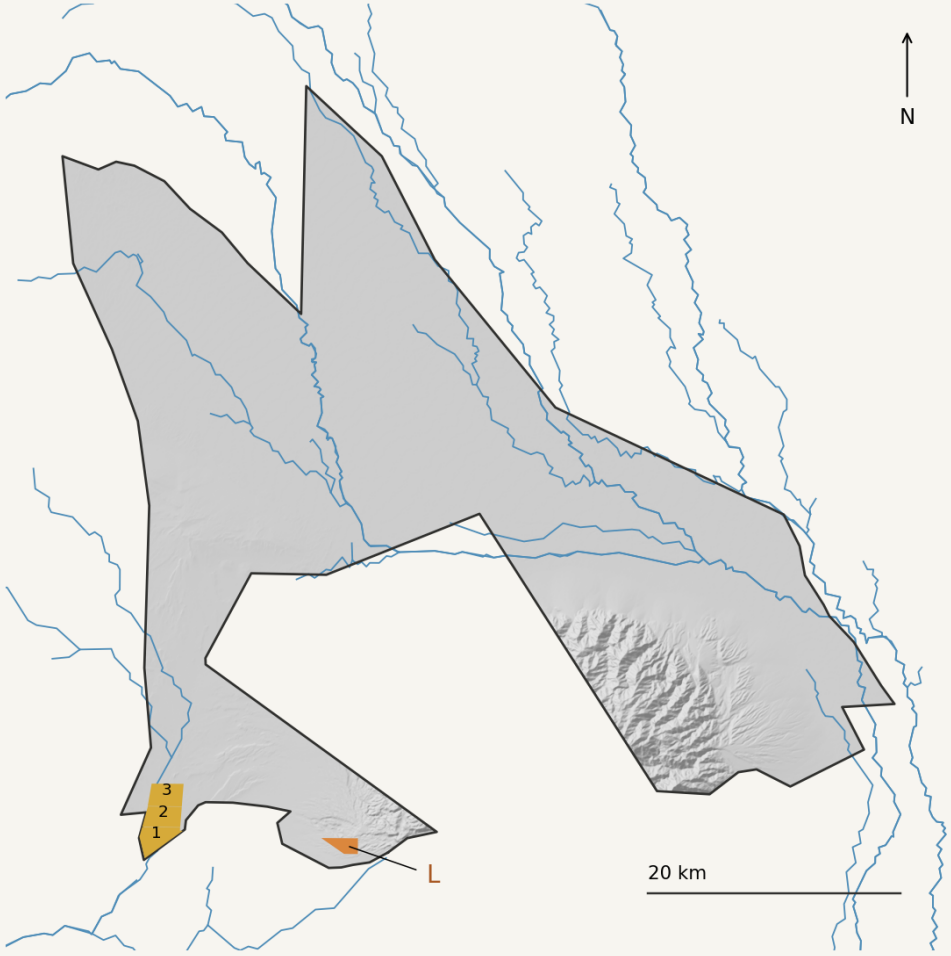


Source: Esri, Vantor, Earthstar Geographics, and the GIS User Community
Accessed 2026-10-27 | multi-date mosaic, not a site survey
Boundary: 2026-10-27-open-seam-closure

RN 40	North–south regional route	27.6 km
RN 20	San Juan and eastern links	40.7 km
RN 141	Eastern regional connection	47.3 km
RN 150	Regional connection towards Chile	52.9 km
RP 510	Eastern provincial road	35.6 km

Distances are the shortest straight-line measurements from the site boundary to each road, not driving distances. Proposals must assess access routes, rights and enabling works.

Early works area



Fixed pilot areas

Agrivoltaics: 13.9 km²

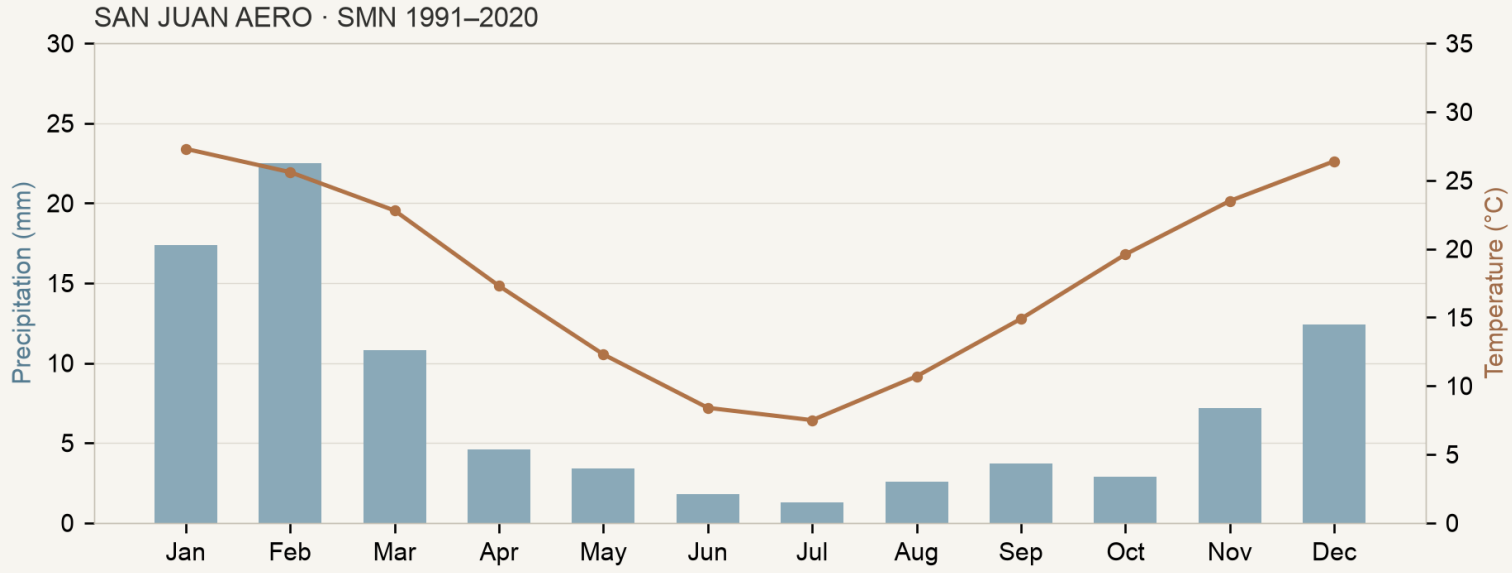
Living quarter: 2.48 km²

XCITY delivers both pilots separately. Keep their boundaries and internal layouts unchanged. Show the land-use, street, water, energy and service connections. Fields 01–03 are numbered on the map; L marks the living-quarter outline.

Assess these interfaces when selecting Phase 1. Do not treat early works as background scenery or assume that every facility shown in the reference information is already operating.

Climate

The region is arid, with little rainfall and marked temperature variation. Heat, intense sun, windblown dust and the Zonda wind should inform street orientation, shade, public space, equipment air intakes, maintenance and cleaning-water demand.



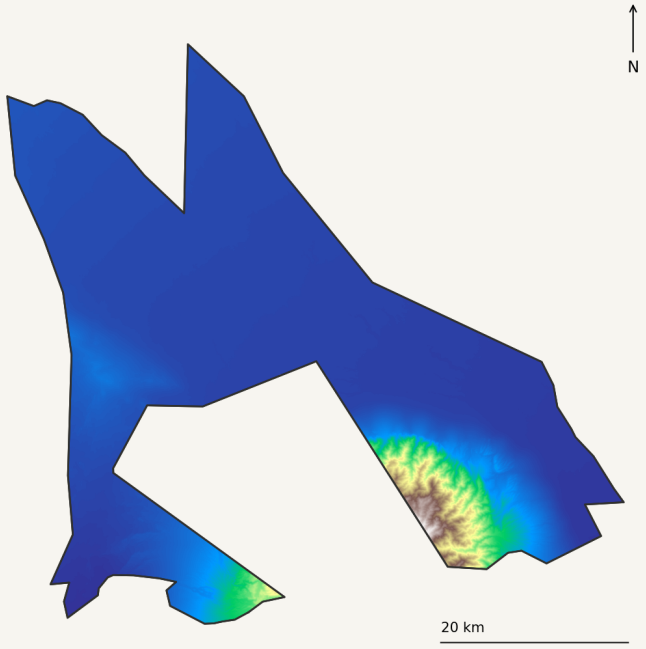
90.5 mm
Annual precipitation

18.0 °C
Annual mean temperature

27.3 / 7.5 °C
January / July mean temperature

Source: Argentina's National Meteorological Service (SMN), SAN JUAN AERO, 1991–2020 normals; station elevation 597 m. The line shows monthly mean temperature, not mean daily maximum. These regional observations do not resolve the site's elevation and local microclimates.

Terrain and slope





Elevation: approximately 636–1,354 m

5th–95th percentiles; maximum approximately 2,658 m

Minimum DEM elevation: approximately 606 m

Slope classes within the competition area

- <2%: ~1,183.6 km²
- 2–5%: ~182 km²
- 5–15%: ~132 km²
- >15%: ~158 km²

Only the authorised open seam at parcels 9/13 is repaired; all other outer edges are retained. Geometry 1,658.819819 km² (2026-10-27-open-seam-closure); nominal project area about 1,656 km², not cadastral verification. Terrain: Copernicus GLO-30 DEM; 60 m grid, 300 m slope smoothing; raster areas indicative.

Hydrology and preliminary development suitability

Seasonal drainage



Drainage lines are classified by DEM-derived upstream catchment area. They show potential flow paths and connectivity, not perennial water availability.

Flood sensitivity screening



Approximately 503 km² falls within 1.5 km of channels draining at least 100 km², and less than 3 m above the channel bed.

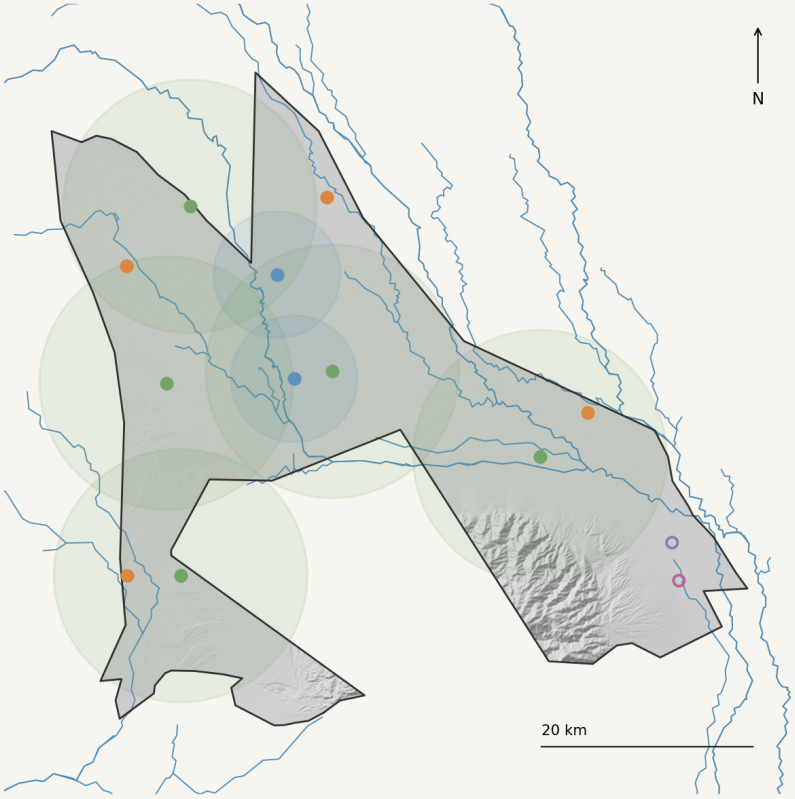
Preliminary suitability screening



Approximately 686 km² has slopes below 2% outside the issued sensitivity screen. This screening does not establish development rights or exclude all other land from design.

Issued package method: 60 m DEM, D8 flow routing and height above nearest drainage (HAND). Upstream flows beyond the analysis extent are excluded. The 503 km² screen is not a surveyed flood limit or a blanket no-build zone. Newly closed seams are unclassified by this prior flood screen. Check water, geology, ecology, land rights and hazards; keep permanent buildings out of dry channel beds.

Five urban systems



Energy and computing

Locate with reliable power, communications and maintenance access. Test cooling, water access, flood safety and buffers to residential areas.

Agricultural production

Connect agrivoltaics, other crops, irrigation, processing and storage. Match the scale of production to resources and servicing needs.

Housing and public life

Compact settlements support services and shared streets. Low-density estates must account for land take, access and service costs.

Industry and automation

Provide processing, manufacturing, repair and internal logistics with each phase. Gateway industries depend on external access and resources.

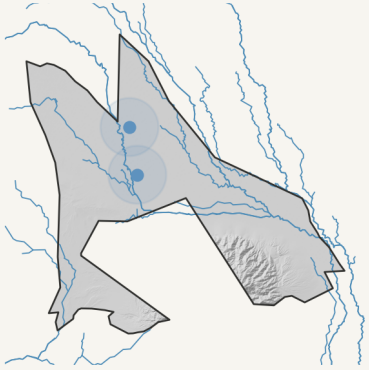
Trade and logistics gateways

Study freight, storage, transfer and future trade functions. Customs, bonded or free-trade status depends on the relevant approvals.

Indicative positions from the issued site package, not fixed sites or land-use boundaries. Proposals may retain, move or challenge them with reasons. Halos show broad intentions, not measured land allocations.

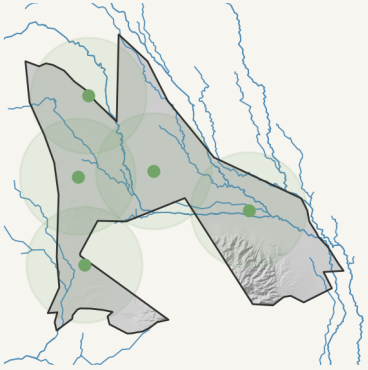
Five urban systems · Individual diagrams

Energy and computing



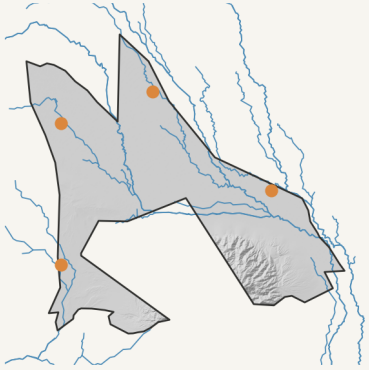
Locate with reliable power, communications and maintenance access. Test cooling, water access, flood safety and buffers to residential areas.

Agriculture



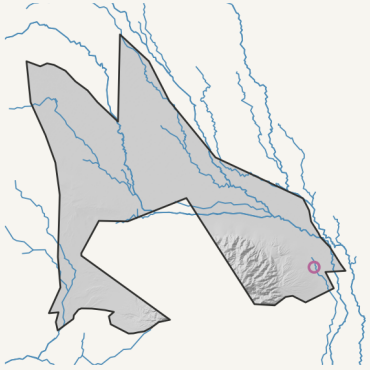
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Housing and public life



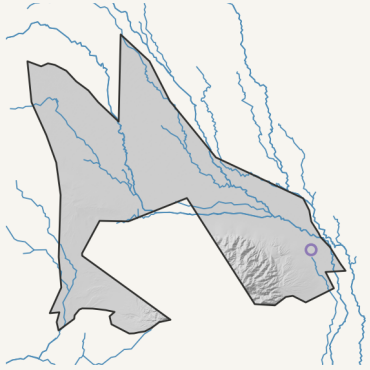
Compact settlements support services and shared streets. Low-density estates must account for land take, access and service costs.

Industry and automation



Provide processing, manufacturing, repair and internal logistics with each phase. Gateway industries depend on external access and resources.

Trade and logistics



Study freight, storage, transfer and future trade functions. Customs, bonded or free-trade status depends on the relevant approvals.

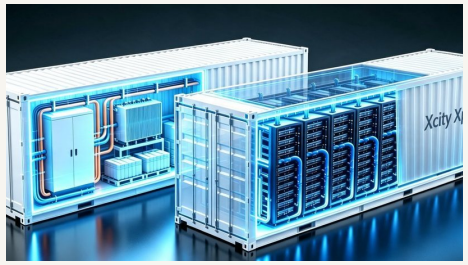
Solid markers show indicative positions from the issued package; hollow markers indicate potential later functions. Halos are not land-use boundaries. Gateway access and timing require testing. The diagrams do not prescribe land-use percentages.

Project systems and reference typologies

The project combines agrivoltaics with modular computing facilities. Retain the system logic while testing spatial, resource and operational interfaces. The images below are project and product references, not photographs of existing facilities on the site.









Agrivoltaics · Under panels and beyond

The organiser confirms forage grass and jojoba as the fixed under-panel crops. Allocation, ratios, irrigation demand and yields are not supplied; state assumptions and verification needs. Keep taller crops and vines outside the panel array. Test mature plant height, solar access, maintenance, animal movement and equipment protection. Agronomic performance requires evidence.

Computing · POD modules and clusters

Use XCITY POD’s modular, factory-integrated and distributed deployment principles to test power, water, fibre, transport, maintenance, fire access and buffers. Nodes may be dispersed outside the urban-design enlargement; first-phase completeness means operational links, not adjacency. Locate main access and explain regional arrival in the overall plan.

Solar generation → Crops and fodder → Grazing and processing → Composting and soil

Vision and objectives

Develop a city where energy, computing and agriculture support productive activity and a complete public life. AI agents and robots should contribute to a coherent urban environment, rather than appear as isolated technologies or showcase buildings.

Objective	What proposals must demonstrate
Resources and capacity	Derive population, jobs, housing and loads from credible water, energy and economic assumptions. Distinguish opening, Phase 1 completion and longer-term capacity.
Shared use of land	Combine energy, agriculture, facilities and urban uses where appropriate, without double-counting land or resources.
Complete public life	Establish education, healthcare, shops, social spaces and leisure for residents and operating staff.
Operational phases	The first phase must function if later development is delayed. State its essential facilities and external dependencies.
People and machines	Make automation compatible with safety, accessibility, public responsibility and the quality of everyday space.

Common Phase 1 reference: 50,000 residents; 20,000 jobs; 200 MW computing load; 1–3 GW solar. Water is not secured: state the assumed source. Teams justify longer-term capacity.

Scope and level of detail

Level	Extent and purpose	Required evidence
Site-wide framework	Cover the full competition area of approximately 1,656 km². Study regional connections beyond the boundary where necessary.	Positioning, development capacity, the five systems, ecology, water, transport, utilities and phasing. Indicative drawing scales: 1:50,000–1:100,000.
Phase 1 urban design	Select and justify the location and extent. No fixed focus-area size is prescribed. Establish a complete first phase that can operate.	Masterplan, land use, streets, public services, open space, utility interfaces, density, height and delivery. Indicative scales: 1:10,000–1:5,000.
Urban design studies	Choose a coherent area or connected areas. Explain the selection, capacity and relationship to the wider systems.	Blocks, plots, building massing, public frontages, servicing, key sections and consistent metrics that test the Phase 1 plan.
Focus areas and strategies	Address the topics on the following page. Combine related topics where useful; isolated landmarks do not substitute for urban design.	Local plans, sections, spatial prototypes, circulation and operational relationships. Indicative local scales: 1:1,000–1:500, with larger sections where needed.

Choose scales to suit the drawing and its purpose. Include boundaries, north arrows, scales, legends and key dimensions. This is a concept planning and urban design competition; statutory submissions, surveys, detailed engineering and construction documents are outside its scope.

Focus areas and strategic topics

Choose three of the six spatial topics for detailed design. Address the other three and all five strategic topics in principle: three in depth, eight in principle. Place every topic within the overall plan and its phase; related topics may share drawings.

Six spatial topics · choose three

01 City entrances and arrival sequences

02 Residential communities and housing types

03 Foothill retreats and spaces for contemplation

04 Logistics hubs and future trade interfaces

05 Computing facilities and heat recovery

06 Streets shared by people and autonomous vehicles

Show local plans and programme, building–landscape–infrastructure interfaces, access and servicing, key sections and spatial prototypes. Use representative views to explain the proposal; the same number of renderings is not required for every topic.

Five strategic topics · answer all

01 Drone landing and docking networks

02 Agrivoltaics and the urban edge

03 Seasonal channels and park systems

04 Places for art and culture

05 Public space in heat, strong sun and windblown dust

Explain the location, principles, users, stage and system interfaces. Plans, axonometrics, sections, process diagrams and system drawings may be used as appropriate.

Programme and development metrics

Provide the following functions and establish the metrics for the proposed population, economic activity and resource scenario. State the area, phase, units, sources and calculation method behind each figure.

Function	Programme	Metrics and evidence
Housing and services	Housing, education, healthcare, shops, culture and administration	Population, homes, land and floor area, service capacity and provision standards.
Computing	Module clusters, cooling, buffers and heat recovery	Phased loads, power supply, cooling method, water demand and heat users.
Energy	Solar generation, storage, distribution and resilience	Installed capacity, energy supply, storage, night and winter operation and disruption response.
Agriculture	Agrivoltaics, other crops, processing and storage	Land, overlapping uses, crops, irrigation and production services.
Industry and logistics	Settlement-based production and internal logistics; future gateway functions	Jobs, land, freight, servicing, connections and triggers for later development.
Transport	Regional access, streets, public transport and active travel	Hierarchy, dimensions, accessibility, coverage and human–machine interfaces.
Utilities	Water, treatment, reuse, communications and waste	Capacity, service areas, prerequisites and sequence of expansion.

Site constraints

Constraint	Design requirement
Channels and flooding	Do not place permanent buildings in dry channel beds. Sensitivity mapping supports site comparison; it is not a statutory flood boundary. Explain safe closure, evacuation and recovery at crossings and activity areas.
Early works	Keep both fixed pilots unchanged: agrivoltaic fields 01–03 and the Phase 1 living-quarter outline. Do not add buildings or redesign within them; show streets, water and service interfaces.
Slopes and hills	Maintain catchment and ecological continuity. Foothill development must address contours, hard surfaces, runoff, access and evacuation. Slope alone does not establish development suitability.
Site boundary	Use the same owner-supplied competition boundary throughout. Graphic connections do not add land or confer cadastral rights.
Water	Separate legal rights, available supply, demand and reuse. Identify unconfirmed conditions as assumptions, with their consequences and verification needs.
Seismic risk and lighting	Plan for emergency access and recovery, with subsequent design subject to applicable local seismic requirements. Control glare, upward light spill and operational lighting.

Design considerations

1 · Industry and programme

Explain the economic relationship between energy, computing, agriculture, manufacturing and logistics, including Phase 1 jobs and skills.

2 · Spatial structure

Test a single-city, multi-settlement or combined approach. Explain centres, neighbourhoods, public services and directions of growth.

3 · Movement and access

Address regional connections, enabling access works, streets, freight, public transport, walking, cycling, autonomous vehicles and drones.

4 · Utilities and energy

Integrate water and reuse; solar generation, storage and distribution; cooling and recovered heat; communications, waste and backup systems.

5 · Ecology and landscape

Address seasonal channels, flood sensitivity, hills and catchments, drought-adapted planting, shade and the productive urban edge.

6 · Urban form and character

Relate density, height and public frontages to heat, wind, dust, earthquakes and evacuation. Include lighting and dark-sky protection.

7 · Delivery

Identify the first works and services, expansion triggers, temporary and permanent facilities, and early decisions that are difficult to reverse.

Key technical questions

1 · Water

Quantify domestic, cooling, agricultural, landscape and industrial demand. Distinguish abstraction, reuse and consumption, and identify priorities under reduced supply.

2 · Jobs and population

Relate opening and Phase 1 jobs, residents and housing. Account for households, commuting, shifts, skills and service populations; do not assume one resident per job.

3 · Night and winter energy

Explain generation, storage and backup arrangements and their implications for facilities, housing, streets and essential services.

4 · People and machines

Show where autonomous vehicles, robots and pedestrians meet. Demonstrate separation, sharing or time-based access through dimensions and operating scenarios.

5 · Expansion triggers

Identify observable conditions for the next phase and hard-to-reverse decisions concerning primary routes, facilities and protected spaces.

6 · Hazard response

Address flooding, earthquakes and strong winds through evacuation, shutdown and recovery strategies. Keep permanent buildings out of dry channel beds.

Phasing and delivery

XCITY will deliver the early works area separately. Proposals must establish the location, extent, content and triggers for urban development phases. Phase 1 should connect to early facilities and provide the production, housing, services and resources needed to operate.

01

Opening and Phase 1

First jobs, homes and public services.
Access, energy, water and operations.

→

02

Subsequent expansion

Growth in residents and economic activity.
Resource and infrastructure thresholds.

→

03

Continued adaptation

Review capacity and risk at each stage.
Protect land and retain system flexibility.

Show a Phase 1/2/3 zoning map and matching table on the A0 boards and in the report. For each zone and phase: new and cumulative residents, dwellings and jobs; objectives, works, relative years or duration, sequence, dependencies and triggers. Reconcile capacities and map IDs; include dispersed facilities. Timing is a scenario, not an approved calendar.

Identify the questions for subsequent specialist work. Future engineering commitments do not substitute for a clear spatial, resource and delivery strategy in this competition.

Submission requirements

Stage 1: initial ideas of up to 10 pages, submitted as a PDF, which may be exported from PowerPoint. Eligibility documents, team details and references are separate and do not count towards the 10-page limit. A full design is not required; Stage 1 is unpaid.

Stage 2 deliverable	Required content
Site-wide framework	Regional and site analysis; spatial structure; the five systems; ecology and water; transport and logistics; utilities and phasing; development capacity and its basis.
Phase 1 urban design	Masterplan; land use and programme; streets and public transport; services and open space; utility interfaces; density, height and delivery plan.
Urban design studies	Blocks and plots; building massing and frontages; service routes; key sections; design guidance and metrics for the same area.
Focus areas and strategies	Local plans; building, landscape and infrastructure interfaces; key sections; use and operating scenarios; representative spatial views.
Technical information	Editable metrics and supporting calculations; resource and phasing analysis; assumptions and sources; the CAD/GIS files and models used, with coordinates, layers and viewing instructions.
Summary and presentation	Six landscape A0 boards; A3 report up to 60 pages including appendices and a requirement-to-drawing index; design statement up to 800 words; one preview image; principal-led online presentation and Q&A.;

Stage 2: English; anonymous boards without practice names or logos. Supply an XLSX metrics workbook and CAD/GIS files. Video and physical models are optional; extra media earn no marks. Include north arrows, scales, dimensions and sources.

Evaluation criteria

Stage 1 · Selection of initial ideas

Criterion	What the panel will assess
Site understanding and direction	Does the initial ideas submission identify the site’s constraints and resources and offer a coherent direction for its systems and first phase?
Relevant work and proposed team	The quality of reference projects, experience with comparable challenges, actual responsibilities, specialist collaboration and team commitment.
Method and deliverability	A clear approach to the questions and evidence that need testing. Rendering quantity and brand recognition do not replace professional judgement.

Stage 2 · Evaluation of full proposals

Site and spatial structure	Site conditions shape siting, centres, corridors and growth.
Systems and resources	Water, energy, computing, population and services support one another.
Urban and spatial quality	Streets, blocks, centres and public spaces serve different users.
Phasing and delivery	Phase 1 operates independently; dependencies and triggers are credible.
Interfaces and further work	Disciplines are coordinated and verification needs are identified.
Communication	Drawings, figures and explanations are clear and consistent.

Criterion weights will be published with the formal rules.

Eligibility and qualifications

The competition is open to professional practices and consortia worldwide. Applicants may prepare their ideas with the rest of the application. Eligibility is reviewed before the ideas are assessed; registration does not secure a Stage 2 place.

Requirement	Evidence
Legal status	A legally registered practice or consortium. Provide a certificate, business registration or an official registry lookup URL; ordinary electronic copies or scans are sufficient.
Professional standing	Provide applicable planning, architectural or landscape permissions, or explain the local regime. The team must cover masterplanning, urban design and landscape/ecological expertise.
Equivalent evidence	Where there is no equivalent practice accreditation system, provide registration, applicable individual professional credentials and evidence of the permitted scope of business.
Experience and team	Identify relevant planning and design work, the team’s actual role, the principal designer and participating staff. Explain specialist input for water, energy, transport and delivery.
Consortia and duplicate entries	Provide an agreement or a statement naming the lead entity, members and responsibilities. A member may not also apply independently or join another consortium in this competition.

Credentials establish professional standing. References, the proposed team and initial ideas of up to 10 pages inform selection. All information must be truthful and verifiable. Disclose relationships or interests involving the organiser or panel members.

Registration and private online application

Apply online: xcityus.github.io/xcity-ai-competition/practice.html#apply

01 Register online

Applications are open. Complete institution, country or jurisdiction, contact and email on the official practice page. No attachments are needed for initial registration.

02 Receive your private link

We will email a private application link. Follow it to the official website; the qualification form and item-by-item checklist are online. The Word worksheet is optional preparation only.

03 Complete and save online

Fill the form; upload evidence or accepted registry/project links, team and references, and a 1-10-page ideas PDF. Save progress and return through your private link. Do not upload a Word form or email attachments.

04 Stage-one review

Register by 31 December 2026, 23:59 UTC. Finally submit the complete online application by 31 January 2027, 23:59 UTC. Five teams are selected in February 2027. Initial registration or saving a draft alone does not complete stage one or mean shortlisting.

Evidence: ordinary PDF/PNG/JPG copies or accepted links; no notarisation. Each file up to 10 MB, all uploads up to 25 MB. Ideas must be a 1-10-page PDF. Contact: competition@xcity.ai.

Stage 1 · Initial ideas of up to 10 pages

Use up to 10 pages to explain your reading of the site, your initial urban proposition and what you would test if shortlisted. This stage is about direction and approach, not a completed masterplan. The five topics below are suggested; allocate the pages as needed.

Suggested topic	What it should communicate
1 Site reading and key questions	Identify the terrain, water, climate, resources and regional relationships that matter most, and the questions you would address first.
2 Site-wide and system ideas	Use a simple diagram to show how energy and computing, agriculture, public life, industry and logistics could work together across the site.
3 Phase 1 rationale	Suggest a starting location or selection principles. Explain how production, housing, public services and essential infrastructure could support one another.
4 A spatial idea or sketch	Illustrate one representative spatial proposition through a sketch, relationship diagram or section. Show how it tests the wider idea; polished renderings are not required.
5 Method and collaboration	Outline your design approach, key assumptions, questions for verification and proposed specialist collaboration.

Format and workload

Submit a PDF of up to 10 pages, which may be exported from PowerPoint. Credentials, team details and references are separate. A complete masterplan, engineering calculations and additional renderings are not required.

Selection and use of ideas

The panel will select five teams using the criteria in Section 13, considering the ideas, reference work and proposed team. Stage 1 is unpaid. Unselected ideas do not grant rights to adaptation or implementation.

Stage 2 · Design honoraria and winner’s award

The five shortlisted teams begin full design work after signing the participation agreement and receiving the complete brief and common site information package. Shortlisting establishes eligibility for the Stage 2 honorarium; it does not trigger an advance payment.

Payment	Allocation	Payment condition
Stage 2 design honoraria	5 teams × US$50,000 Subtotal: US$250,000	Payable following a complete, valid Stage 2 submission in accordance with the brief and participation agreement, irrespective of ranking.
Additional winner’s award	1 team × US$50,000	Paid to the winning team after the result is announced, in addition to its Stage 2 honorarium.
Total	US$300,000	The winner receives US$100,000 in total. Each of the other four teams receives US$50,000.

What counts as a valid submission

Submit the required Stage 2 material and respond substantively to the design task. Eligibility is reviewed beforehand. Completeness checks and design evaluation are separate; a lower ranking does not remove the honorarium.

What the payments cover

Stage 1 is unpaid and there is no Stage 2 advance. No separate design-development award is offered. Later design services are outside these payments. Tax treatment, payment documents and settlement procedures are governed by the participation agreement.

Briefings, jury process and use of submissions

Online briefings and common information

No site visit will be organised. The organiser will provide a common site information package, an online briefing and coordinated Q&A.; Material clarifications and updates will be shared with every participant in the relevant stage.

Jury process

A jury of qualified experts will evaluate submissions against the published criteria. Jurors must disclose conflicts of interest and recuse themselves where appropriate. Jury details will be shared through the competition’s official contact channel once confirmed.

Publicity and terms

Authors retain copyright and are responsible for originality and third-party permissions. Stage 2 participants grant the organiser a non-exclusive licence to use submissions for competition evaluation, exhibition, publication and publicity, with credit. This does not automatically include adaptation, implementation or unrelated commercial use. Stage 1 ideas are for selection only; public display requires the author’s consent.

The organiser may invite the winning team to discuss a further design commission. Scope, fees and rights to adapt or implement the work will be agreed separately. Winning does not itself create a further appointment. Honoraria and awards will not be deducted from separately agreed fees for subsequent services.

Site information

Information	Use and limitations
Boundary and early works	A common set of spatial files and accuracy notes. Competition area: approximately 1,656 km²; fixed pilots: agrivoltaics 13.9 km² and a living quarter 2.48 km².
Location and imagery	Regional context, satellite imagery and roads. Credit imagery sources and distinguish a multi-date mosaic from a site survey.
Terrain and hydrology	Elevation, slope, seasonal drainage, flood sensitivity and preliminary suitability screening, with methods and limitations.
Systems and references	Indicative system locations, agrivoltaic concepts and POD images. Reference concepts do not establish fixed locations or verified performance.
Versions and assumptions	Identify the version and source of information used. Record uncertainty and unconfirmed resource conditions, with their implications.

Site information, answers and amendments will be issued through a common channel. Maps do not replace cadastral, water-rights, hydrological or specialist verification. Gaps in organiser-supplied information are not, in themselves, grounds for marking down an applicant or proposal.

Contact

XCITY

International Masterplanning and Urban Design Competition

Online registration is open on the official practice page. We will email a private link to complete the qualification form and uploads on the official website. Save progress and finally submit online; do not email application attachments. All applicants follow the same application requirements, eligibility review and selection criteria. Common documents, clarifications and notices are issued through the official competition channels. Contact the competition team below for questions.

Online application: xcityus.github.io/xcity-ai-competition/practice.html#apply

Email: competition@xcity.ai